deputy prime minister had conversely suggested to Nehru that there was little benefit to being in the lead, and it would be better if India were "somewhat late in the company of others."[103] But even he thought that recognition was inevitable.[104]

American officials in Britain, China, India, and the US tried to delay Indian recognition.[105] London persuaded Delhi to delay by two weeks, but on December 10, K. P. S. Menon informed Henderson that Delhi was likely to recognize the communist regime toward the end of the month. On December 19, mentioning the British intention to recognize, he confirmed that India would recognize Mao's government on December 30.[106] On that day, India made a public announcement that it would be willing to recognize the communist Chinese government.

Even at that point, Delhi and Washington were not on entirely different pages when it came to China. Like Indian officials, Acheson believed that the communists controlled the mainland and that Mao was not a "true satellite" of the Soviets. Meeting with the Joint Chiefs of Staff in late December, he questioned whether the effort to delay the fall of Taiwan was worth it. He said the US should instead focus on strengthening China's neighbors by building their stability and prosperity, and on supporting nationalist movements in the region—a strategy with which Nehru would have concurred.[107]

But there was no concurrence on recognition. Acheson told his British and French counterparts that recognition would serve no purpose and would only worry American partners in Asia. Many US allies leaned toward recognition, but the administration agreed with members of Congress that the US should not recognize Mao's regime. Chinese mistreatment of US nationals, including diplomats,[108] reinforced this view.[109] From Delhi, Henderson, while noting that the Indian leadership would vociferously criticize the US for not recognizing China, asserted that the US should not do so. He believed it would adversely affect American credibility because countries in the region would see it as a sign of weakness.[110]

China hawks in the US gave the administration little credit for not recognizing the Chinese communist regime. Senator Knowland moreover criticized it for not doing enough to stop or at least delay Indian recognition.[111] China bloc criticism only increased when Truman and Acheson stated publicly in early January 1950 that the US would neither